sanas South African National Accreditation System

# NON-CONFORMANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND CLEARANCE REPORT

SANAS No.: T1195

Organisation Name: AZURE SKY PTY LTD.

NC Report Number: NC 01

Area/Scope Assessed: Coal testing

Assessor / Inspector / Expert: N Chitiyo

## PART 1: DETAILED OBSERVATION

The platform scale used for sample preparation (AU025PA) is moved around when sample is weighed at different stages posing an accuracy risk

Signed (Representative):

Signed (Team Leader / Inspector):

MAJOR: [X] MINOR: [ ]

Reference No. of relevant Guide / Standard / Requirement: ISO/IEC 17025 Clause 7.4/6.4

Date: 07/04/26

## PART 2: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

*(Provide an analysis of the extent and cause of the nonconformity)*

- This is as a result of CAB not documenting the significance of keeping balances in their natural positions.

- This resulted in personnel not understanding the importance of keeping balances in ~~the~~ their natural position.

## PART 3: CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

*(Clearly indicate what corrective action was taken, and attach supporting evidence of implementation)*

An internal memorandum for the control of equipment and/or balance has been issued. It outlines the factors that influence proper functioning of the balance and how it affects accuracy. The memo prohibits the movement of balances/scales from allocated stations without authorisation from management.

Date: 13/04/2026

Signed (Representative):

## PART 4: CORRECTIVE ACTION VERIFIED AND CLEARED

*(Comment on whether the corrective action is sufficient and appropriate)*

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

## PART 5: FOLLOW-UP AT NEXT ASSESSMENT

*(Comment on the implementation of the corrective actions)*

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:



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AS004MF 07/25

# BRAINSTORMING FORM

**IRQ no:** NCo1 (SANAS)

**Brainstorming team**

Sifiso Nyambi
Tshepo Maponya
Abenathi Jama
Nosipho Hlongwane

What went wrong?

The platform scale used for sample preparation (AS025PA) is moved around when sample is weighed at different stages posing an accuracy risk.

Why 1: Why was a platform scale moved around?

It was moved from it ~~original~~ original position to weigh the sample where it was received

Why 2: Why the sample was weighed where it was received instead of the original position of the platform scale?

- Incomplete system documentation
- Lack of understanding of significance of the process

Reason

-This is as a result of the CAB not documenting the significance of keeping all balances in their natural position.

- This resulted in personnel not understanding the significance of keeping balances in their natural positions.

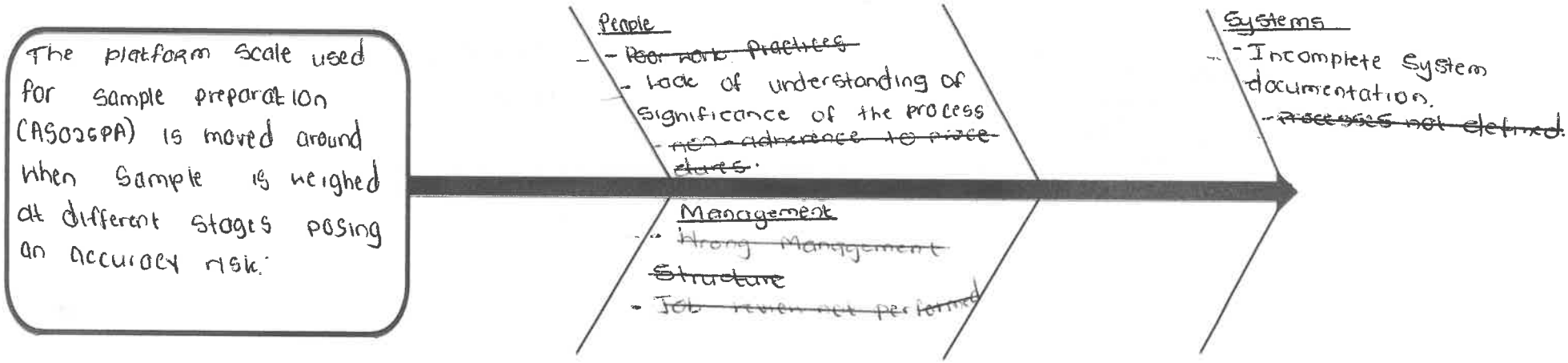
**Supervisor:**

AS001MF

07/25

# ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS FORM

**IRQ NO:** NC01 (SAMAS)




**SUPERVISOR**

| | Equipment Management | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Document no:<br>7.4 Memo | | |
| | *Compiled by:* | Tshepo Maponya -<br>Laboratory Supervisor | |
| | *Approved by:* | Nonhlanhla Msibi -<br>Operations Manager | |

**INTERNAL MEMORANDUM**

To: All Laboratory Personnel

From: Sifiso Nyambi

Compiler: Sifiso Nyambi

Approved by: Nonhlanhla Msibi

Date: 13/04/2026

**Subject: Control of Equipment Movement and Balance Stability (ISO/IEC 17025 Clauses 6.4 & 7.4)**

## 1. Purpose

The purpose of this memorandum is to address the improper movement of the platform scale during sample preparation processes, which poses a significant risk to measurement accuracy and data integrity. This memo establishes strict controls in line with ISO/IEC 17025 requirements.

## 2. Scope

This instruction applies to all laboratory personnel involved in weighing, sample preparation, and handling of measuring equipment.

## 3. Requirement

In accordance with ISO/IEC 17025 Clause 6.4 (Equipment) and Clause 7.4 (Handling of Test Items), all weighing equipment, including balances and platform scales, shall remain in a fixed, controlled position during operation. No equipment shall be moved without prior authorization from laboratory management.

## 4. Instruction

Effective immediately (13-04-2025)

- No balance or platform scale is to be moved once calibrated and verified for use.

| Revision | Initial Date | Next Rev Date |
|---|---|---|
| 00 | 04/2026 | 04/2029 |

- Any requirement to relocate equipment must be approved by laboratory management.
- Upon relocation, the equipment must undergo re-verification, leveling, and, where applicable, recalibration before use.
- Unauthorized movement of equipment will be treated as non-conformance.

## 5. Factors Affecting Balance Stability

The following environmental and operational factors significantly influence balance performance and measurement reliability:

- Air currents and drafts cause drift in readings.
- Temperature fluctuations affect internal components.
- Vibration from nearby equipment or foot traffic.
- Unstable or uneven surfaces affecting leveling.
- Electrostatic charges influence mass readings.
- Magnetic fields interfering with electronic balances.
- Improper leveling of the balance.
- Humidity variations affecting sample mass.
- Operator managing and inconsistent weighing techniques.

## 6. Compliance

Failure to comply with this instruction may result in invalid test results and compromise the laboratory's accreditation status. All personnel are required to adhere strictly to this directive.

## 7. Records

All equipment movement, maintenance, and verification activities must be documented in the equipment logbook in accordance with quality system procedures.

## 8. Revision History

| Revision | Date | Description | Approved By |
|---|---|---|---|
| 00 | 13-04-2025 | Initial issue | Nonhlanhla Msibi |

| Revision | Initial Date | Next Rev Date |
|---|---|---|
| 00 | 04/2026 | 04/2029 |

| AzurESky | ATTENDANCE REGISTER | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Document no: | Version: | Page: |
| | ASMF 17043-8.4.1 | 0 | 1 |
| | *Compiled by:* | Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager | |
| | *Approved by:* | Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager | |
| Date: | 13/04/26 | | |
| Chair: | Sifiso M. | Scribe | |
| Subject: | Balance/Scales protocols | | |
| Absent: | | | |

| Present | Cell Number | Designation | Signature | Email address |
|---|---|---|---|---|
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BEFORE



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|---|---|---|
| AzurESky | **Equipment Management** | |
| | **Document no: ASMF 6.4 Proc** | |
| ***Compiled by:*** | **Tshepo Maponya - Laboratory Supervisor** | |
| ***Approved by:*** | **Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager** | |

**1. Purpose & Scope**

This procedure outlines the selection, identification, calibration, and maintenance of all laboratory equipment. This applies to all "critical equipment"—any hardware or software that can significantly influence the accuracy of laboratory results.

**2. Selection and Verification**

Before any equipment is placed into service (whether it is brand new or returning from repair), it must be verified.

- **Action:** The lab Manager/Supervisor compares the equipment's performance against the manufacturer's specifications or the laboratory's method requirements.
- **Record:** Identification & Verification results are noted in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register).**

**3. Identification and Labelling**

All equipment listed in the register shall be uniquely identified with a dedicated equipment number.

- **Calibration Labels:** Equipment must be labelled with its calibration status, indicating the **date of last calibration** and the **due date for the next calibration,** where necessary.

**4. Handling, Transport, and Storage**

To prevent contamination, damage, or deterioration:

- Equipment must be used only by authorized personnel.
- Sensitive instruments (e.g., balances) must be protected from vibrations and extreme temperature shifts.
- If equipment is transported outside the lab, it must be re-verified upon return before being used for testing.

- **Service Providers:** Calibration is performed by accredited facilities (refer to **ASMF 6.2** for subcontracting/service provider assessment).
- **Intermediate Checks:** Where necessary (e.g., calorimeter, scales), "intermediate checks" are performed between calibrations to maintain confidence in the equipment's status.

**6. Non-Conforming Equipment**

If equipment has been subjected to overloading, mishandling, gives suspicious results, or is shown to be defective:

- **Isolate:** It must be taken out of service immediately.
- **Label:** A clear **"OUT OF SERVICE"** or **"DO NOT USE"** tag must be attached.
- **Investigate:** The lab must evaluate the impact of this defect on previous test results and initiate the non-conformance procedure if necessary.

**7. Safeguarding**

Equipment hardware and software shall be safeguarded from adjustments that would invalidate the test results. This includes password protection for software and physical seals on calibration-sensitive screws or knobs.

KINDLY NOTE THAT NO EQUIPMENT (BALANCES, CRUSHERS, FURNACES, HOMOGENEITY DRUM, PULVERISERS, OVENS) IS TO BE MOVED WITHOUT AUTHORISATION FROM MANAGEMENT.

**8. Revision**

| Revision no | Content changed | Reason for revision |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | -Removal of action and record under section 2.<br>-Addition of clause that prohibits the movement of equipment without authorisation. | - Simplify section 2. Selection and verification process of equipment.<br>-Prevent re-occurrence of an NC (shifting equipment). |
| | | |

| Effective date | Rev status | Next review date |
|---|---|---|
| 04/2026 | 01 | 04/2029 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| AzurESky | **Equipment Management** | |
| | **Document no: ASMF 6.4 Proc** | |
| | ***Compiled by:*** **Tshepo Maponya - Laboratory Supervisor** | |
| | ***Approved by:*** **Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager** | |

## 1. Purpose & Scope

This procedure outlines the selection, identification, calibration, and maintenance of all laboratory equipment. This applies to all "critical equipment"—any hardware or software that can significantly influence the accuracy of laboratory results.

## 2. Selection and Verification

Before any equipment is placed into service (whether it is brand new or returning from repair), it must be verified. Verification can be done in any of the following ways: calibration/efficiency test.

## 3. Identification and Labelling

All equipment listed in the register shall be uniquely identified with a dedicated equipment number.

- **Calibration Labels:** Equipment must be labelled with its calibration status, indicating the **date of last calibration** and the **due date for the next calibration, where necessary.**

## 4. Handling, Transport, and Storage

To prevent contamination, damage, or deterioration:

- Equipment must be used only by authorized personnel.
- Sensitive instruments (e.g., balances) must be protected from vibrations and extreme temperature shifts.
- If equipment is transported outside the lab, it must be re-verified upon return before being used for testing.

## 5. Calibration and Maintenance

- **Calibration Program:** The lab follows a schedule as defined in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register).**